INTEGRAL DRAGON

• AI-ACCELERATED SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT | ENSEMBLE HEALTH PARTNERS

Applied Practice — Week 1 Update

What we built this week, how Applied Practice works in front of participants, and a preview of the quality-signals work that's taking shape alongside it.

What we shipped this week

Week 1 of Applied Practice is in hand. The expanded curriculum for Workshop 1 — "What Good Looks Like" — is complete, reviewable, and ready to stand in front of participants.

DELIVERED · WORKSHOP 1 EXPANDED

Full hands-on curriculum

Six exercises, instructor notes, participant handout, talk-track, and a workshop-flow diagram. Rewritten around a repeatable inspect-score-improve-rescore loop instead of a one-off scorecard exercise.

DELIVERED · REUSABLE

Claude-assisted scorecard skill

A repo-local skill participants invoke during the workshop. Claude gathers e the codebase; participants score against nine health categories; the skill is any project afterward.

DELIVERED · SCAFFOLDING

Structure for Workshops 2–5

Expansion maps for all four remaining workshops drafted, so the week-over-week build is incremental rather than a ground-up restart each time.

DELIVERED · SUPPORTING

Operating-model instructions

Standing instructions for "Ensemble Claude" — the instance used inside En environment — covering the scorecard workflow, provenance requirements, compliant permission configuration.

How Applied Practice works in front of participants

Every workshop follows the same shape. It's deliberately repeatable — the muscle we're building is the loop, not any single exercise.

STEP 01
Define good
Participants start from a shared definition of project health — not opinions.

→

STEP 02
Inspect
Claude Code gathers evidence against the definition, from their actual codebase.

→

STEP 03
Score
Humans — not AI — decide what the evidence means and how to score it.

→

STEP 04
Improve
One small, reviewable change is made — validated by tests and review.

→

STEP 05
Rescore
Run the scoreca
Capture the delt
next priority.

GUARDRAILS WE TEACH ON DAY ONE

- Claude collects evidence. Humans own scoring and improvement decisions.
- Improvements must be small enough to review — no speculative rewrites.
- Every improvement is validated before it counts.

The five-workshop arc

Each workshop builds on the last. Outputs from one become inputs to the next — scorecards become friction maps become candidate changes become validated improvements become a team operating model.

WORKSHOP 01 · DONE

What Good Looks Like

Establish the quality target. Build the scorecard skill. Produce the baseline.

WORKSHOP 02 · QUEUED

Technical Debt as Friction

Turn the baseline into a friction map. Prioritize by cost-of-change, not opinions.

WORKSHOP 03 · QUEUED

AI Inspect & Improve

Aim Claude at the top friction items. Produce reviewable candidate changes.

WORKSHOP 04 · QUEUED

Validation

Tests, observability, security. A change only counts when it's validated.

WORKSHOP 05 ·

Make It Repe

Turn one-off cle
30-day team pr
working agreem

Quality Signals Assessment Module

Running in parallel to the workshop build: a module that turns what the workshops teach into an ongoing quality read on any codebase. Designed to produce **signals**, not scoreboards.

WHAT IT IS

A module — not a dashboard product

The module gathers evidence from a repository and its delivery systems, and surfaces stable patterns: which files always show up in rework, which cycle-time segments are dragging, which review-discipline habits are slipping. The output can be rendered as a report, a dashboard, or fed into an existing tool.

WHY SIGNALS, NOT SCORES

Less political, less gameable

Scores invite argument about what to count. Signals report what the
is doing, with every value sourced to a specific query. A signal that r
across two consecutive windows is treated differently than a one-of
consistency is the headline, not any single number.

WHERE THIS SITS IN THE PROGRAM

Workshops teach the practice. The Quality Signals module is the artifact that lets a team continue the practice after the workshops end — and lets leadership s
the investment in engineering health is actually paying off, without asking engineers for self-reported metrics.

A sample output

WORK IN PROGRESS · MOCKUP

What the module's first output looks like. This is a mockup against a fictional service — we're not there yet. It shows the *shape* of what leadership would see, and the level of evidence-backing behind every number.

RECURRING FINDINGS	TOP-3 CHURN FILES	MEDIAN PR CYCLE
8 of 10 top items	**Same 3** both months	**18h / 21h** m1 / m2
PROD ROLLBACKS	**TRACE COVERAGE**	**CONSISTENCY**
2 / 2 m1 / m2	**3 of 11** hot paths	**Strong** across two windows

THE POSTURE WE'RE TAKING

- Every number resolves to an ADO query, a git command, or a scheduled scan — not to an opinion.
- Signals that recur across two consecutive windows are treated as structural. Single-window findings are flagged as tentative.
- No dollar / cost conversions in the first run. Those come later, once the signals themselves are trusted.

What happens next week

Justin will run an instructor-led demo implementing part of the Quality Signals module live — in front of the cohort, against real artifacts. Not the full module. A focused slice that lets us see what lands with participants and what needs tightening.

SCOPE OF THE DEMO

- Justin implements part of the assessment module live — scoped, not the full thing.
- Participants see Claude collecting evidence in real time, with provenance captured as it happens.
- The output of the demo becomes the starting artifact Workshop 2 consumes.

WHAT WE'LL LEARN

- Whether the "signals, not scores" framing lands for engineering participants.
- Whether the provenance workflow is practical at the speed of a
- Where the module needs more scaffolding before it can run with instructor support.

WHAT THIS SETS UP

By the end of next week we'll have Week 1 delivered, a working demo of the Quality Signals module in front of real participants, and concrete feedback to fold i Workshops 2–5 and the module build.

Week 1 shipped. The Quality Signals module is taking shape alongside the workshops. Next week we put a slice of it in front of real participants.

OPEN TO ALIGN ON

- Is the "signals, not scores" framing one leadership wants us to keep?
- Anyone leadership would like us to loop in on the Quality Signals work, given where it intersects with engineering analytics already in place?
- Any constraints on the data the module can touch in the next demo that we should know about before next week?